

aged 0-2 years shouldn't have any exposure to technology, while those between 3-5 years should be restricted to it for one hour per day, and those between 6-18 years should be allowed two hours per day. These rules however apply if gaming is the focus of the interaction. If the kid is a student using the device as a productivity tool, you can take a call on how much longer you'll allow access.

5. Children below the age of 10 must be constantly monitored so you know what exactly they're doing. Besides them exploring unsavoury media, there's also the danger of anti-social elements luring them (read: paedophiles and kidnappers). Keep media screens in family areas so that a child's media usage can be monitored. It goes without saying that TVs and computers should be kept out of bedrooms.

A tablet called The Fable could be useful. It comes loaded with a special content management system designed to protect kids from inappropriate content and unfamiliar people.

6. Talk to your child about the risks online. You can't always control what kids use computers for so it's best to teach them how to use it safely. Teach them what tech is good for and explain why to avoid the bad parts. Educate kids to critically think and they will filter out the bad for themselves.
7. Give them plenty of loving attention. Dr. Carolyn Jaynes, a learning designer for Leapfrog Enterprises, suggests: "You can help your child get more out of a smartphone or tablet by sharing in the experience. Engage with your child as he tries out a new app, asking questions about the game and pointing out different aspects of the content. This practice, typically called 'co-viewing' when applied to TV-watching, can help increase your child's comprehension skills."

Jeannie Galindo, supervisor of instructional technology for the Manatee County School District in Florida says, "In an unsupervised environment, I wouldn't recommend a smartphone or tablet purchase for a child until at least between the ages of 11 and 13."

8. When making age-appropriate media choices, it's important to focus on the content and message.
9. You owe it to your child's safety and well-being to learn about new technologies and social networks, in particular. Tech is here to stay and unless you understand how technology and social network sites work and what they offer, especially in terms of security, you won't be able to help your child. Model responsible usage of technology yourself.